



A WORDS HAVE WEATHER STORY EBOOK

Mina and the Missing Shoe

A four-minute morning storm



THE HOOK

Four minutes

The front door felt a thousand footsteps away - and the bus was due in four minutes. Mina had one yellow sock, one red shoe and no blue shoe anywhere.



THE PRESSURE LINE

A line lands

Alex looked at the clock. "Why do you always make us late?" The words came out faster than Alex meant them to.



POSSIBLE WORD-WEATHER

The hallway shrinks

Mina stopped looking. A small grey cloud gathered around her shoulders. Willo's leaf ears dipped. "She may hear that she is the problem," Willo said.



KEEP THE BOUNDARY

The bus is still coming

Alex breathed out. The time did not change. School did not disappear. But the next sentence could.



REPAIR

Try the next sentence

"That came out sharp. We still need to leave. We can look together for one minute, or you can wear the red pair. Which works?"



A SMALL CHOICE

Red will do

Mina did not smile. She looked once more behind the basket, then pulled on the other red shoe. "Red," she said.



CARRY IT FORWARD

Not perfect. Possible.

They reached the corner as the bus rolled near. The blue shoe was still missing. The morning was still hurried. But Mina was not the thing that needed fixing.



READ IT AGAIN

What changed the weather?

The boundary stayed: they had to leave. The weather shifted when Alex repaired the label, named the real problem and made the next step small enough to choose.



TRY IT TOGETHER

Two shoes, two sentences

Say the pressure line once. Pause. Then try: "We need to leave. Look together for one minute, or wear the other pair?" Ask the child which version gives them more room to think.



WILLO WONDERS

Where did the problem go?

In the first line, Mina sounded like the problem. In the next line, the missing shoe and the deadline became the problem adults and children could face together.

Adult notes

Key message: keep the leaving boundary and separate the child from the problem. Try: (1) act out both sentences with two toy shoes; (2) draw the weather each line might create; (3) rehearse two acceptable choices before the next rushed morning. With younger children, use fewer words and show the choices. A calm sentence may help; it does not guarantee immediate cooperation.

